Hamzah Zuhrah

Cybersecurity Student at ODU | NCDAC Secure Systems & Compliance | Seeking SOC, GRC & Security Operations Roles
Raleigh-Durham-Chapel Hill Area | (984) 399-5834 | szhamzah20@gmail.com | Portfolio | GitHub | linkedin.com/in/hamzah-z-15b55317b

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student at Old Dominion University (GPA 3.97, expected May 2027) with experience spanning secure public-safety operations, IT support, compliance-focused workflows, and security engineering. Seeking SOC analyst, security operations, cybersecurity analyst, GRC, compliance, IAM, vulnerability-management, and junior security engineering opportunities.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security: Incident response, network security, threat modeling, vulnerability assessment, access control, system hardening, phishing analysis, cryptography, NIST CSF 2.0, NIST SP 800-61r3, security documentation

GRC & Compliance: Audit readiness, policy and procedure adherence, evidence handling, confidentiality, role-based access, regulated system use, risk identification, incident reporting, clearance-sensitive workflows

Systems & Networking: Linux/Kali Linux, Windows, macOS, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, routing and switching fundamentals, Nmap, packet analysis, Wireshark, virtual machines

Programming & Tools: Python, Bash, Git, GitHub, automated testing, secure protocol design, structured audit logging, TLS 1.2+, AES-256-GCM, scrypt

State / Justice Systems: OPUS, OMNIXX, DCI, and multiple clearance-controlled state systems

Cloud: AWS IAM, EC2, S3, cloud architecture, encryption, monitoring, and cloud security fundamentals

SELECTED CYBERSECURITY PROJECT

Secure File Transfer System v2 2026

- Built a security-focused Python client/server system that encrypts files locally with streaming AES-256-GCM before upload, authenticates users over verified TLS 1.2+, and stores only authenticated ciphertext on the server.
- Implemented salted scrypt credential storage, per-account/IP rate limiting, per-user authorization boundaries, versioned length-prefixed JSON framing, SHA-256 transfer verification, structured audit logs, atomic writes, and path-traversal defenses.
- Created automated tamper and failure-path tests and documented explicit trust boundaries.

APPLIED SECURITY RESEARCH

Independent Research Opportunity - COVA CCI Ongoing

- Researching encrypted DNS security and privacy, examining how DNS over HTTPS and DNS over TLS affect user privacy, network visibility, performance, and defenders' ability to detect DNS-based threats.
- Supporting the research with a practical Wireshark demonstration comparing traditional DNS visibility with encrypted DNS behavior.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Telecommunicator | Special Operations & Intelligence Unit (SOIU) | NC Department of Adult Correction Sep 2026 - Present
Raleigh, North Carolina | *On-site* | *Full-time*

- Use OPUS, OMNIXX, DCI, and multiple clearance-controlled state systems while following role-based access, identity-verification, confidentiality, and authorized-use requirements.
- Receive, evaluate, document, and disseminate sensitive, time-critical information to appropriate personnel and operational units.
- Maintain accurate system records and communication logs that support traceability, auditability, policy compliance, and reliable incident response.
- Apply governance, risk, and compliance principles by following state and departmental procedures for access control, records handling, information sharing, and escalation.

Information Technology Trainee | Gateway Homes, Inc. May 2026 - Aug 2026
Remote | *Apprenticeship*

- Helped staff with basic computer and printer issues and set up computers and workstations for employees.
- Installed software updates, performed routine system checks, and assisted with password resets and user account support.
- Organized computer equipment, kept inventory up to date, escalated complex technical issues to the IT team, and provided day-to-day office support.

IT Help Desk Intern | Moog Space and Defense May 2025 - Aug 2025
Internship

- Provided Tier 1 IT help desk support for end users in a defense-oriented technical environment, resolving common workstation, software, access, and peripheral issues.
- Troubleshot hardware and software problems, supported account-access requests, performed routine system checks, and helped maintain reliable day-to-day technology operations.
- Documented support requests and technical resolutions, escalated complex issues when needed, and collaborated with technical teams to improve user support and process reliability.

Residential Supervisor | NeuroRestorative Jan 2022 - May 2025
Blacksburg, Virginia

- Promoted through progressively responsible roles from Life Skills Trainer to Medication Administrator, Team Leader, and Residential Supervisor.
- Administered medications, maintained medication inventory, received and stocked supplies, and completed medication incident reports.
- Led shifts and coordinated daily operations; as Residential Supervisor, supported compliance and audit readiness and coordinated teams, hiring, schedules, budgets, and operational logistics.

EDUCATION

Old Dominion University | Bachelor's Degree, Cybersecurity | May 2027 (Expected) | GPA: 3.97

CREDENTIALS

AIG - Shields Up: Cybersecurity Job Simulation | AIG | Issued Oct 2026

Mastercard - Cybersecurity Job Simulation | Mastercard | Issued Sep 2026

Professional development: Preparing for CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701)